



Partly sunny 82/67 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 84/66 B20

Democracy Dies in Darkness

THURSDAY, AUGUST 7, 2025 • \$4

Criticism on human rights is set to ease

Draft reports on Russia, Israel, El Salvador show softer stances from U.S.

BY ADAM TAYLOR,
HANNAH NATANSON
AND JOHN HUDSON

Leaked drafts of the State Department's long-delayed annual human rights reports indicate that the Trump administration intends to dramatically scale back U.S. government criticism of certain foreign nations with extensive records of abuse.

The draft human rights reports for El Salvador, Israel and Russia, copies of which were reviewed by The Washington Post, are significantly shorter than the ones prepared last year by the Biden administration. They strike all references to LGBTQ+ individuals or crimes against them, and the descriptions of government abuses that do remain have been softened.

The draft report for El Salvador — which, at the Trump administration's urging, has agreed to incarcerate migrants deported from the United States — states that the country had “no credible reports of significant human rights abuses” in 2024. The State Department's previous report for El Salvador, documenting 2023, identified “significant human rights issues” there — including government-sanctioned killings, instances of torture, and “harsh and life-threatening prison conditions.”

Several Venezuelans whom the Trump administration sent to a Salvadoran prison said they were subjected to repeated beatings.

The leaked draft reports for El Salvador, Israel and Russia underscore how the Trump administration is radically rethinking America's role in global human rights advocacy. The documents also are consistent with internal guidance circulated earlier this year by State Department leaders who advised staff to truncate the reports to the minimum required by statutory guidelines and executive orders signed by President Donald Trump, and to remove references to government corruption, gender-based crimes and

SEE RIGHTS ON A4

Japan marks eight decades since atomic bombing



RICHARD A. BROOKS/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Lanterns float on a river in Hiroshima, Japan, on Wednesday during commemorations for the 80th anniversary of the United States' atomic bombing of the city during World War II. It was followed days later by a detonation over Nagasaki. The bombings, the only uses of a nuclear weapon in war, precipitated the conflict's end the next month.

Fight over Texas's map has gone nationwide

Politicians in both parties push for raw partisan tactics in redistricting

BY HANNAH KNOWLES

The fight over Republicans' push to redraw the Texas congressional map has widened into a national political war, with red and blue states moving to counteract each other and ambitious politicians around the country vowing aggressive partisan combat.

From California to New York, Democrats are pushing to redraw their state's maps to add more blue seats if Texas Republicans

carve out five more red ones, as they are trying to do this month. Republicans from Missouri to Ohio have expressed interest in changing their U.S. House district lines to benefit the GOP, and Vice President JD Vance is headed Thursday to Indiana, another state that could boost his party.

Midterm candidates and potential 2028 presidential contenders are playing to their base and raising their profile while jumping into the fray. And President Donald Trump is weighing in, declaring this week that

SEE TEXAS ON A8

Bomb threat: Lawmakers at hotel in Illinois evacuated for probe. **A7**

Today's WorldView: Other nations have redistricting solutions. **A8**

Trump revisits vow of a 'safe and beautiful' D.C.

His threat of a takeover follows order stepping up federal law enforcement

BY NATALIE ALLISON
AND OLIVIA GEORGE

When a young man pulled out a marijuana joint in Logan Circle park and proceeded to smoke it on a bench one evening last month, three law enforcement officers quickly appeared, handcuffed him and took him away.

The officers were with the U.S. Park Police. And they were there to enforce one of President Donald Trump's executive orders: “Making the District of Columbia

Safe and Beautiful.”

The man was one of four people arrested that evening in Logan and Dupont Circle parks — both of which are federal land. The other three were charged with possession of open containers of alcohol. The arrests, which generated outrage from some residents, were among the latest operations that White House officials say are part of an effort to improve the quality of life in the nation's capital — a city Trump has derided as a “dirty, crime-ridden death trap” and pledged to turn around.

Trump amplified his campaign Tuesday, sharing a photo of a

SEE D.C. ON A6

National Guard in D.C.? Trump issues threat over local crime. **B13**

After 10 years, this actor still tells Hamilton's story

The last original cast member of the Broadway hit just about lives in the room where it happens

BY HANNAH SAMPSON

Thayne Jasperson has left the building. Don't worry. Just for lunch. It happens sometimes.

The actor is in the middle of a grueling two-show day, that show being the smash hit “Hamilton,” which opened at the Richard Rodgers Theatre on Broadway 10 years ago Wednesday. And for this day's midday meal of a salad with salmon and piles of freshly grated parmesan, he's only ventured across the street.

Jasperson, a member of the ensemble who pops up briefly as the snooty British loyalist Samuel Seabury, is the only remaining original cast member in the show about founding father Alexander Hamilton. He's still thrilled to be in the room where it happens, finding new ways to make sure starring in a pop culture phenom-

enon doesn't become just another job. It's a running joke that he's moved into the building. Fans predict he'll haunt the place one day — they call him the Phantom of the Rodgers.

Earlier this year, he even recorded a tongue-in-cheek video series called “At Home (The Richard Rodgers) with Thayne Jasperson.”

“Thayne has done so many dispatches from that theater, it's hard not to believe that he lives there,” Lin-Manuel Miranda, the show's creator, said in an email.

“It feels like I live there,” Jasperson said.

He has certainly made himself at home. He keeps a cozy robe in the dressing room he shares with several cast members. He sometimes handwashes laundry there, grabs a nap, takes a shower. You'll find him doing pre-show pull-ups

SEE HAMILTON ON A20



EVELYN FREJA/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Thayne Jasperson, a member of the “Hamilton” ensemble, takes a break at the Richard Rodgers Theatre in New York.

Lithium a potential key in treating Alzheimer's

Research showing role of metal in brain function could yield new therapies

BY MARK JOHNSON

Seven years of investigation by scientists at Harvard Medical School has revealed that the loss of the metal lithium plays a powerful role in Alzheimer's disease, a finding that could lead to earlier detection, new treatments and a broader understanding of how the brain ages.

Researchers led by Bruce A. Yankner, a professor of genetics and neurology at Harvard Medical School, reported that they were able to reverse the disease in mice and restore brain function with small amounts of the compound lithium orotate, enough to mimic the metal's natural level in the brain. Their study appeared Wednesday in the journal Nature.

“The obvious impact is that because lithium orotate is dirt cheap, hopefully we will get rigorous, randomized trials testing this very, very quickly,” said Matt Kaerberlein, former director of the Healthy Aging and Longevity Research Institute at the University of Washington, who did not participate in the study. “And I would say that it will be an embarrassment to the Alzheimer's clinical community if that doesn't happen right away.”

Yankner, who is also the co-director of the Paul F. Glenn Center for Biology of Aging Research at Harvard, said: “I do not recommend that people take lithium at this point, because it has not been validated as a treatment in humans. We always have to be cautious because things can change as you go from mice to humans.” He added that the findings still need to be validated by

SEE ALZHEIMER'S ON A2

Vaccine funding: Experts lament targeting of mRNA projects. **A15**

IN THE NEWS

Five soldiers shot at Army base A fellow service member at Fort Stewart in Georgia was apprehended. All of the victims were expected to recover. **A4**

New tariffs President Donald Trump said he will raise import taxes on India to 50 percent, citing its purchases of Russian oil. **A15**

THE NATION
The L.A. fires have been linked to hundreds of deaths, far more than previously reported. **A7**
Dozens of workers at FEMA have been reassigned to support deportation efforts. **A7**

THE WORLD
Karol Nawrocki, a Trump-backed historian, was sworn in as Poland's president. **A12**
A journalist in Georgia was sentenced to two years in prison, drawing global criticism. **A13**

THE ECONOMY
Once a mall staple for teens and tweens, Claire's filed for bankruptcy for the second time in seven years. **A14**
A member of British Parliament struggling to field constituent messages encouraged them to use a chatbot clone of himself, eliciting ire. **A16**

STYLE
With so many consumer interactions prompting a survey, how much do ratings matter? **B1**
SPORTS
Terry McLaurin wants a new contract. For Jayden Daniels's sake, the Commanders have to get it done, columnist Jerry Brewer writes. **B7**

THE REGION
The corpse flower at the U.S. Botanic Garden has bloomed: Here's the stink on the *Amor-phophallus titanum*. **B13**
LOCAL LIVING
Experts share advice on how to address five of the most common issues with growing your own tomatoes.

BUSINESS NEWS.....A14
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B16
OPINION PAGES.....A17
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A12

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54301

